

PERSONAL JOURNAL OF LEGOLAS GREENLEAF

12 Narbeleth, Third Age 2987

Dear diary, today I spent the greater part of the afternoon in conversation with Lord Elrond.

I have long considered him among the wisest beings remaining in Middle-earth, yet I continue to discover new reasons for that opinion.

What began as a discussion concerning the preservation of ancient texts soon wandered into subjects I could scarcely follow.

Lord Elrond spoke at length regarding what he called *language modals*.

I assumed he referred to the structure of Sindarin and Quenya.

It quickly became apparent that he meant something else entirely.

He then introduced a concept called a *vector embedding*.

According to his explanation, ideas may be arranged according to meaning rather than location, allowing hidden relationships to emerge naturally.

I informed him that this sounded suspiciously like wizardry.

He assured me it was reasoning.

I asked how a vector embedding could possibly improve reasoning.

He began discussing language modals.

When I asked what language modals were, he informed me that the answer could not be understood without first understanding reasoning.

By this point I was no longer certain what question I had originally asked.

Lord Elrond, however, appeared perfectly comfortable.

Indeed, he seemed mildly surprised that I found any of it difficult.

At one point he remarked that these were merely basic concepts.

I elected not to challenge him on this point.

There are occasions when wisdom consists of recognizing the limits of one's understanding.

This was such an occasion.

I confess that I understood perhaps one sentence in four.

Yet I remain convinced that Lord Elrond knows exactly what he is talking about.

Whether anyone else does is a different matter entirely.

Should I ever find myself responsible for preserving the accumulated knowledge of Middle-earth, I hope he agrees to explain these matters again.

Preferably more slowly.